

RELIEF / SUBSTITUTE TEACHER PACK · YEAR 7–8 · HPE

■ SELF-CONTAINED — NO PREP REQUIRED

WATER SAFETY

Relief Teacher Pack

Health & Physical Education · Year 7–8 · 50-minute self-contained lesson
Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · VCHPEP125 · VCHPEP130 · VCHPEM146

5 min

Settle & intro

10 min

Key concepts

25 min

Scenario groups

5 min

Share-back

5 min

Exit ticket

A Quick Start — Everything You Need to Know

■ No preparation required. This pack is entirely self-contained.

Read this page, then go to Section B (What You Need) and Section C (Lesson Plan). Everything else — scenarios, key facts, DRS ABCD — is in this document.

What students already know

- Beach flags and their meanings
- The 5 LSV SwimSafe rules
- Basic rip current awareness
- DRS ABCD (introduced in earlier lessons)

Use their prior knowledge as your starting point.

Your goal for this lesson

- Consolidate existing water safety knowledge
 - Apply knowledge to realistic scenarios
 - Reinforce: Throw, Don't Go
 - Reinforce: rip escape technique
 - Reinforce: DRS ABCD steps
- No new content — application and consolidation.

If students have questions you can't answer

- Say: "Good question — write it down for your regular teacher"
- Use the Key Facts panel in Section E
- Do NOT feel pressure to know everything
- You can say: "Let's work through it together"

The scenarios are designed to prompt thinking, not test your knowledge.

B What You Need

Materials — all already in the classroom or in this document

- This printed document (or display on the board from [water_safety_relief_teacher_pack.html](#))
- Whiteboard or large paper for the class brainstorm
- Scenario cards — cut from Section D or display on board (6 scenarios, groups of 4–5)
- Student workbooks or blank paper for the exit ticket
- Timer (phone is fine)

Class management tips

- Groups of 4–5 work best — assign groups yourself, do not let students self-select
- Each group gets one scenario card — assign Scenarios 1–5, Scenario 6 is Extension for fast finishers
- Write the lesson structure on the board at the start so students can see the plan
- The exit ticket question is on this sheet — collect them before students leave

C 50-Minute Lesson Plan

5 min Settle & Introduction

Write on the board: "Water Safety — What Do We Already Know?"

1. Introduce yourself. Tell students this is a water safety consolidation lesson — they've covered this content and today they apply it.
2. Ask the class: "Who can name one of the 5 SwimSafe rules?" Take 2–3 responses. Write them on the board.
3. Tell students: "Today you're going to work in groups on a real-life water safety scenario. Your job is to figure out what to do and why."

10 min**Key Concepts Refresh**

Whole class, teacher-led — use the DRS ABCD strip in Section E if needed.

1. Quickly run through DRS ABCD as a class. Ask: "Who remembers what each letter stands for?" Use Section E to confirm answers.
2. Ask: "What do you do if you see someone in trouble in the water and you can't swim well?" (Answer: Throw, Don't Go — find something to throw.)
3. Ask: "If you're caught in a rip, what should you NOT do?" (Answer: Don't swim against it — you'll exhaust yourself. Float, swim parallel, angle back in.)
4. Briefly show the beach flag meanings on the board — red/yellow, single red, orange windsock. Ask students what each means.

25 min**Scenario Group Activity**

Students work in groups of 4–5. Each group receives one scenario card.

1. Assign groups (do not let students choose). Give each group a scenario card from Section D.
2. Groups discuss their scenario and prepare to share: What are the hazards? What should the person do? What is the correct order of actions?
3. Walk around the room and listen in. Prompt quiet groups with: "Have you talked about DRS ABCD?" or "What SwimSafe rules apply here?"
4. After 15 minutes: give groups 2 minutes to prepare a 1-minute verbal share-back.

5 min**Share-Back**

Each group shares their scenario and the key decision. Keep it brief.

1. Call on each group in order. Ask them to: (1) describe their scenario, (2) say what the person should do, and (3) name one water safety rule or concept that applies.
2. If there is disagreement between groups, facilitate a brief class discussion.
3. Confirm the correct answers using Section E (Key Facts).

5 min**Exit Ticket**

Individual written response — collect before students leave.

1. Students complete the following on a slip of paper or in their workbook:
 1. Name ONE thing you would do differently near water after today's lesson.
 2. Write ONE question you still have about water safety.
4. Collect responses and leave them with the recording sheet (Section F) for the classroom teacher.

D Scenario Discussion Cards — Cut or Display

Print and cut the cards below, or display each scenario on the projector. Assign one scenario per group. Scenario 6 is extension for fast-finishing groups.

SCENARIO 1

Red Flag Day

Mia and her friends arrive at the beach on a hot summer afternoon. They walk past the surf club and see that a single red flag is flying — but there are no lifeguards on duty. The beach looks beautiful and the water looks calm. Her friends want to go in.

Discuss: What does a single red flag mean? Should they swim? What should they do instead? Where is the safest place to swim?

Key concepts: beach flags, patrolled vs unpatrolled, single red flag, SwimSafe rules

SCENARIO 2

River After Rain

Jake and two friends are riding bikes near a river after heavy rain two days ago. The water looks brown and fast but not huge. One friend says "It's not that deep, let's cross here — we've done it heaps of times before." The usual crossing point is where they always go.

Discuss: What are the risks of crossing the river? Why is a familiar crossing point more dangerous after rain? What should they do?

Key concepts: inland waterways, flood risk, familiar locations, SwimSafe rules, risk assessment

SCENARIO 3

Not Moving

Jayden is at a friend's backyard pool party. He looks over and sees someone floating face-down. They are not moving. There are four other people nearby on their phones. No-one is reacting.

Discuss: Walk through the DRS ABCD steps exactly. What do you do first? What do you say when you call 000? Why isn't anyone else reacting?

Key concepts: DRS ABCD, bystander effect, 000, Throw Don't Go

SCENARIO 4

Pulled Out to Sea

Sophie is swimming between the flags at a patrolled beach. She suddenly feels water pulling her strongly away from shore. She's a decent swimmer and her instinct is to swim back to shore as hard as she can.

Discuss: Is Sophie's instinct correct? What should she actually do? What would happen if she followed her instinct? How do you signal for help?

Key concepts: rip currents, panic response, float and signal, swimming parallel to shore

SCENARIO 5

The Dare

A group of Year 8 students are at a farm property. Someone dares them to jump off a jetty into a dam "because it's fun and they've all done it before." It's 35 degrees and the water looks cool and calm.

Discuss: What are the hazards they can't see? Which SwimSafe rules are being broken? How do you say no to a dare without losing face?

Key concepts: hidden hazards, SwimSafe rules — enter feet first, peer pressure, dam safety

SCENARIO 6 — EXTENSION

The Inflatable

Zoe and her family are at the beach. It's a hot, sunny day with light wind. An orange windsock flag is flying near the surf club. Zoe's younger brother wants to take his inflatable ring into the water. Their parents say it should be fine because "the water looks calm today."

Discuss: Are the parents right? What does the orange flag specifically mean? What could happen? What should Zoe say to her parents?

Key concepts: beach flags, orange windsock, offshore winds, inflatables, family safety communication

E DRS ABCD Quick Reference & Key Facts

D	R	S	A	B	C	D
DANGER	RESPONSE	SEND 000	AIRWAY	BREATHING	CPR	DEFIB
Check it is safe before approaching	Tap shoulders. Call their name loudly	Call 000 or direct someone to do it	Tilt head back to open the airway	Look, listen, feel — 10 seconds	30 compressions : 2 breaths. 100–120 bpm. Hard & fast.	Use AED if available. Attach and follow voice prompts

Key Facts — If Students Ask

Red & yellow flags	Always swim between these flags — lifeguard is on duty. This is the safest place to swim at a patrolled beach.
Single red flag	Dangerous conditions. Experienced swimmers only — extreme caution. Do NOT enter unless you are a trained swimmer and aware of the conditions.
Orange windsock flag	Offshore winds are blowing. NO inflatables — they will be blown out to sea and cannot be retrieved without a boat.
Rip currents	Do NOT swim against a rip — you will exhaust yourself. Stay calm. Float. Swim parallel to shore (sideways). When out of the rip, angle back in. Raise one arm to signal for help.
CPR compression rate	30 chest compressions : 2 rescue breaths. Rate: 100–120 beats per minute (same tempo as "Stayin' Alive"). Depth: 5–6 cm. Allow full chest recoil between compressions.
SwimSafe 5 rules	1. Read signs 2. Enter feet first (never dive into unknown water) 3. Stay in depth 4. Swim with a friend 5. Signal for help (raise ONE arm)
Throw, Don't Go	NEVER enter the water to rescue someone unless you are trained. A panicking person can pull an untrained rescuer under. Throw a rope, towel, pool noodle, or anything floatable. Call 000 first.
Secondary drowning	After any submersion incident — even if the person seems fine — they should be medically assessed. Fluid in the lungs can develop hours later. Always seek medical review.

F Recording Sheet — Leave This for the Classroom Teacher

Relief Teacher: Please complete this sheet and leave it on the teacher's desk together with any collected exit tickets.

DATE	CLASS	RELIEF TEACHER NAME
LESSON COMPLETED?		☐ Yes, fully ☐ Yes, partially ☐ No (circle one)

Scenario group notes:

Scenario Group	Students (names or numbers)	How the group went — notes for the classroom teacher
Scenario 1 — Red Flag Day		

Scenario 2 — River After Rain		
Scenario 3 — Not Moving		
Scenario 4 — Pulled Out to Sea		
Scenario 5 — The Dare		
Scenario 6 — Extension (if used)		

Behaviour or welfare concerns to note:

Write here if relevant — leave blank if nothing to note

Exit ticket summary (leave if collected, or note key themes students raised):

Key themes, misconceptions, or standout responses...